JPas

Reference Guide

Version 1.0 (Draft)

Copyright © 2017
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Available under MIT License at:
https://github.com/ashurrafiev/JPas

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1. Introduction

JPas is an interpreter of Pascal-like language, called *JPascal*, running in Java Virtual Machine (JVM). It supports a variety of features, including console input and output, as well as graphical interface, mouse and keyboard events.

> **Note:** *JPascal language draws its inspiration from early Turbo Pascal (TP) versions 3.0–5.0, before the object oriented programming was introduced. Hence the source of this work lies before 1990s. And this* **note** *also contains a keyword.*

Why?

No reason. Honestly.

1.1 About JPascal

JPascal language draws its inspiration from early Turbo Pascal versions 3.0–5.0, before the object oriented programming was introduced. Hence the source of this work lies before 1990s.

However, JPascal adds some modern look to this old language. For example, it allows in-place declarations of variables and other elements. Most notable feature is a benefit of working under JVM, the garbage collection automatically frees unused memory, hence manual tracking and disposing of pointers is no longer required in JPascal.

1.2 JPascal versus Classic Pascal

JPascal adds new features and removes some from the classic Pascal. Many of the changes are done because of JPas environment is running in JVM.

JPascal is a higher level programming language than TP. Most of the removed features are linked to a specific system architecture.

Keywords that existed in Classic Pascal, but have not been added to JPascal:

absolute	**goto**	**packed**	**unit**
external	**inline**	**program**	
file	**interrupt**	**set**	

1.2.1 Program structure

Program does not start with the keyword **Program**, and units do not start with **Unit**. In fact, these are not keywords in JPascal.

Minimal "Hello world" program in Classic Pascal:

```
Program Hello;
Begin
  WriteLn('Hello world!');
End.
```

In JPascal it becomes a one-liner:

```
WriteLn('Hello world!').
```

1.2.2 Variable, type, and constant declarations

There are no dedicated declaration blocks (apart from the **interface** part in a unit), all declarations can be done in-place, anywhere in the code.

1.2.3 Unit structure

Interface/implementation structure is not limited to units, however it is not very useful anywhere else. The syntax is also different, as shown below.

In classic Pascal:

```
Unit UnitName;
interface
{Public declarations.}
implementation
{Implementation and private declarations.}
Begin
{Unit initialisaton code.}
End.
```

In JPascal:

```
interface
{Public declarations.}
implementation
{Unit initialisaton code with implementation.}
end.
```

1.2.4 Basic data types

Integer numbers are represented only with Integer type, which represents 32-bit signed integer numbers. There are no Byte, Word, or LongInteger.

Real is implemented using double precision floating point numbers (64-bit).

String type does not take size as a parameter. The strings have variable length realised by Java strings.

No *packed* data types; **packed** is not a reserved keyword.

1.2.5 Enumerated types

Enumerated types are defined using square brackets [and] instead of parentheses (and). This is done for consistency with array and record literals, see Section 1.2.7.

1.2.6 Records

Variant records and tag fields are not possible.

It is not allowed to declare a pointer of type ^T before T is declared. For example, the following code is valid in classic Pascal, but will give a compilation error in JPas.

```
{Classic Pascal only!}
type
  PersonPtr = ^Person;
  Person = record
    Name: String;
    Age: Integer;
    Next : PersonPtr;
  end;
```

However, you can still use ^T within the declaration of T:

```
{In JPascal:}
type Person = record
    Name: String;
    Age: Integer;
    Next : ^Person;
  end;
```

1.2.7 Array and record literals

Array and record literals are defined using square brackets [and] (unlike regular parentheses (and) in classic Pascal. Because of this, you can use array and record literals anywhere in the code. Regular parentheses would make no distinction between single-value array and a parenthetic expression.

1.2.8 Sets

Sets are not added in this version of JPas, and probably will not be added any time soon. Even though it is a nice feature, it has a very limited application, so may not worth time investment. In the current implementation of JPas, **set** is not a reserved keyword

1.2.9 Files

Version 1.0 of JPas does not support working with files, however this functionality may be added later in one way or another. At the moment, **file** is not a keyword, and Text is not a reserved identifier.

1.2.10 for loops

Counter may be any L-value, not just a variable. You are allowed to change the counter inside the loop body. Starting and ending conditions are still evaluated only once, before the loop starts.

1.2.11 Pointers and memory addressing

JPas interpreter implements its own memory structure based on Java objects, which is different from the classical DOS memory model. It is not possible to get numerical addresses of memory items. As the result, pointer arithmetic is not possible.

Mem and Port arrays, provided in TP, do not exist in JPas. Almost all of the memory access functions and procedures are also removed.

No *absolute* access; **absolute** is not a reserved keyword.

Overlays are meaningless to modern systems, so they haven't been added to JPas.

1.2.12 Garbage collection

On the bright side, the memory management became much easier thanks to JVM's Garbage Collector (GC).

In the classic TP, it was mandatory to call either Dispose or Mark/Release for every pointer allocated by the function New. Failing to do so would lead to memory leaks.

In JPas, disposing of unused memory is done by GC, and there are no such functions as Dispose, Mark, and Release.

```
var Q: ^Integer;
begin
  var P: ^Integer;
  New(P); {Allocate memory.}
  P^ := 8;
  Q := P;
end; {Variable P is destroyed.}

{The memory is still referenced by Q.}
WriteLn(Q^); {Prints '8'.}

Q := nil; {Clear the pointer.}
{Memory is automatically unallocated
because there are no pointers referencing it.}
```

1.2.13 Functions and procedures

No untyped arguments because absolute access is not allowed.

No **external** , **inline**, and other procedural modifiers.

No procedural types or function pointers.

1.2.14 Labels, exit and goto

Labels do not need an in-advance declaration. In JPascal, a label marks a statement.

goto statement has been deprecated in many languages. JPascal does not implement it.

Most interesting behaviour can be realised using **exit** Label statements, which exits the statement marked with the label. This always guarantees safe behaviour. It is still possible to use **exit** without a label to exit a function, procedure, or the program, like in Classic Pascal.

2. Language Elements

...

2.1 Whitespace and Comments

Whitespace is any number of tabs, spaces and newline characters in any combination. A comment is any text enclosed in curly braces { and }, or between (* and *). Whitespaces and comments are ignored by the parser.

2.2 Keywords and Identifiers

The list of keywords:

and	**exit***	**nil**	**to**
array	**for**	**not**	**type**
begin	**forward**	**of**	**until**
case	**function**	**or**	**uses**
const	**if**	**procedure**	**var**
div	**implementation**	**record**	**while**
do	**in****	**repeat**	**with**
downto	**interface**	**shl**	**xor**
else	**label**	**shr**	
end	**mod**	**then**	

* **exit** was a function in Classic Pascal, not a keyword.

** In the current version of JPas, **in** is a registered keyword, but the operator is not yet implemented.

Identifier is a sequence of characters including Latin letters, numbers and underscore. It must contain at least one letter and cannot start with a number. Identifiers can be used as names for variables, constants, types, functions, procedures, etc.

The list of registered identifiers:

Boolean	False	Real	True
Char	Integer	String*	

* String was a keyword in Classic Pascal, now it is considered a registered identifier.

Identifiers and keywords are case-insensitive. It is considered a good programming style to write keywords in lower case and start identifiers in capital case. The exceptions are the main **Begin** and **End** keywords of the program, which are usually capitalised, and local variables with single-character names, e.g. x or y, which can be lower case.

2.3 Operator symbols

Operator symbols recognised by JPascal are:

;	*	=	@
,	/	<>	^
:	[	>	.
:=	]	<	..
+	(	>=	
–	)	<=	

2.4 Constant Literals

2.4.1 Numeric literals

Any sequence of digits 0–9 form a decimal integer number. Unary 'minus' operator – creates a negative number. Unary 'plus' operator + can be optionally used to emphasise positive numbers. In JPascal, integer numbers are 32-bit, hence specifying numbers larger than $\left(2^{31}-1\right)$ or smaller than $\left(-2^{31}\right)$ will produce a compilation error.

Hexadecimal integer literals are preceded with $ symbol. It is possible to specify larger numbers in hexadecimal format, but they will be cropped to 32-bit with overflow. For instance, $FFFFFFFF will produce decimal (-1).

```
{Integer numbers:}
123
–8
+8 {Same as 8}
00025 {Same as 25}
$FF {Decimal 255}
$FFFFFFFF {Decimal –1 (overflow).}
```

Real numbers have integer and fractional parts separated by . (period). Scientific notation is also allowed. Examples are shown below.

```
{Real numbers:}
0.01
3.141592
2.5E-6 {Same as 0.000025}
2.5E+6 {Same as 250000}
1E9 {1000000000.0 – one billion as a real number.}
```

Note: *Scientific notation always produces real numbers, so they need to be explicitly converted to integer.*

```
Int(1E9) {Now it is an integer number.}
```

There is an implicit cast from Integer to Real type.

2.4.2 Character and string literals

Strings of characters enclosed in single quotes ' produce string or character literals. Character literals contain exactly one character. JPascal supports Unicode managed by Java. All characters are 16-bit.

```
'Hello, I am a string.'
'A' {...and this is a character.}
```

It is also possible to create single character constants from their ANSI/Unicode values by preceding a decimal or hexadecimal numeric literal with a hash # symbol.

```
{Characters from ANSI/Unicode values:}
#48 {Same as '0' (zero)}
#65 {Same as 'A' (Latin A)}
#$41 {Also 'A' (Latin A)}
#$03A9 {Capital Greek Omega Ω}
```

There is an implicit cast from Char to Sting type.

2.4.3 Built-in constants

Boolean constants True and False.

Null-pointer constant **nil** is a keyword.

3. Program Structure

...

JPascal program is a single statement ending with . (period) symbol. “Hello world” program in JPascal looks like this:

```
WriteLn('Hello world!').
```

WriteLn outputs information to system console, which in this case is the string literal ‘Hello world!’.

Statement is defined as an executable action. Statements can be compound, internally executing more statements. For example, a block statement **begin** ... **end** is used to combine a sequence of multiple statements into one. Statements within a block statement are separated using semicolons.

```
Begin
  WriteLn('Hello world!');
  WriteLn('JPascal is here.');
  WriteLn('Bye!')
End.
```

This sections gives a brief overview of statements and program structuring. A detailed reference on statements can be found in the Section 7 of this guide.

3.1 Types of statements

Statements can be one of the following types:

- Empty statement.
- Declaration statements include variable, constant, type, function, and procedure declarations.
- Inclusion statement **uses**.
- Interface statement **interface** ... **implementation** ... **end**.
- Block statement.
- Control statements include exit, branching and loop statements.
- Assignment.

- Procedure call or expression statements.
- Scope statements include only **with** statement.

...

4. Variables and Constants

...

5. Types

...

5.1 Simple Types

5.2 Enumerated and Subrange Types

5.3 Array Types

5.4 Record Types

5.5 Pointers

...

6. Expressions

...

7. Statements

...

7.1 Block Statements

7.2 Declaration Statements

...and other.

8. Procedures and Functions

...

9. Units

...

10. Standard Procedures and Functions

...

Unlike user-defined procedures, the standard procedures and functions are processed by the pre-compiler in a special way, which opens the following advantages:

- Functions and procedures may take arguments of unspecified types or multiple specific types. For this reason, in this section you can see argument types like Ordinal or SomeType.
- The same function or procedure name can be used by different functions. The choice of the actual function depends on the types of the arguments (this is called *overloading*). The most notable example of overloading is type of the result being dependent on the type of the argument, like in Min, Max, or Abs functions.
- Variable number of arguments, here denoted as X, ..., means 0 or more arguments like X.

...

10.1 Execution Control

10.1.1 Halt

```
procedure Halt;
```

Stop the program execution end exit JPas with exit code 0 (no error). This is the same as calling **exit** statement from the main block of the program; however, Halt can be called from anywhere in the code.

10.1.2 RunError

```
procedure RunError(Msg: String);
```

Stop the program execution with the runtime error and the specified message *Msg*. JPas exits with the code 1 (error).

10.2 Pointers

10.2.1 New

```
procedure New(var Ptr: ^SomeType);
```

10.3 Console Input and Output

10.3.1 Write and WriteLn

```
procedure Write(Value, ...);
procedure WriteLn(Value, ...);
```

10.3.2 Read and ReadLn

```
procedure Read(var Target, ...);
procedure ReadLn(var Target, ...);
procedure Read(var Line: String);
```

10.4 Time

10.4.1 Delay

```
procedure Delay(Milliseconds: Integer);
```

10.4.2 SysTime

```
function SysTime: Integer;
```

10.4.3 Elapsed

```
function Elapsed: Real;
```

10.5 Math Functions

...

```
function Pi: Real;
function ArcTan(X: Real): Real;
function Sin(X: Real): Real;
function Cos(X: Real): Real;
function Exp(X: Real): Real;
function Ln(X: Real): Real;
function Sqrt(X: Real): Real;
function Frac(X: Real): Real;
function Int(X: Real): Integer;
function Round(X: Real): Integer;

function Abs(X: Real): Real;
function Abs(X: Integer): Integer;
function Sqr(X: Real): Real;
function Sqr(X: Integer): Integer;
function Min(X: Real): Real;
function Min(X: Integer): Integer;
function Max(X: Real): Real;
function Max(X: Integer): Integer;
function Odd(X: Integer): Integer;
```

10.6 Ordinal Functions

...

```
procedure Inc(var Ordinal);
procedure Dec(var Ordinal);
function Inc(Ordinal): Odrinal;
function Dec(Ordinal): Ordinal;
function Ord(Ordinal): Integer;
function OrdinalTypeName(Integer): Ordinal;
```

10.7 Strings and Characters

...

```
function Chr(Code: Integer): Char;
function UpCase(C: Char): Char;
function UpCase(S: String): String;
function LowCase(C: Char): Char;
function LowCase(S: String): String;
function Format(Fmt: String; Value, ...): String;
function Str(Value): String;
procedure Val(S: String; var Target; var Code: Integer);
function Copy(S: String; StartPos, EndPos: Integer): String;
function Length(S: String): Integer;
function Pos(S, Target: String): Integer;
procedure Concat(var Target: String; S, ... : String);
procedure Delete(var Target: String; StartPos, EndPos: Integer);
procedure Insert(var Target; S: String; StartPos: Integer);
```

10.8 Arrays and Memory

...

```
procedure Fill(var Target: Array of SomeType; Value: SomeType);
procedure Swap(var X, Y: SomeType);
```

10.9 Random Number Generator

...

```
procedure Randomize;
procedure Randomize(Seed: Integer);
function Random;
function Random(N: Integer);
```

11. Graph2D Unit

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